أَطَابَ

Ataaba

4 PARTIES · 116 VERS

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KIRAAM

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

أَطَابَ

Ataaba

أَطَابَ لِي الْمَمَرُّ كَالْأَوْطَانِ

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Œuvre de Cheikh Ahmadou Bamba Khadimou Rassoul

4 parties · 116 vers · mètre Rajas

English translation only

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PARTIE I

Ataaba 1

1. An Everlasting One (Al-Bāqī), Who has preserved me from Satan, has made the passage (of exile) pleasant for me like homelands.

2. I have begun in the Name of Allah, the All-Merciful (Ar-Raḥmān) and the Most Merciful (Ar-Raḥīm), the King of the ages.

3. He has opened, He Whose Name is the Opener (Al-Fattāḥ), for a Chosen One whose name is the Key (Al-Miftāḥ).

4. It has become clear to everyone who has righteousness that praising the Chosen One (Muḥammad) is success.

5. The Verses of Aḥmad have encompassed the Books of those to whom the Lord of creatures and of time gave revelation.

6. Our Prophet, al-Māḥī (the Effacer), has effaced all sorrow from us, just as he has accepted from us what was balanced.

7. Muḥammad — may the Possessor of beginningless Eternity bless him — my services gladden him perpetually.

8 Our Aḥmad, the Chosen, has turned harm toward others, away from my direction, forever, and (likewise) peril.

9 He has made endure the peace of our Lord, the Expediter (Al-Muqaddim), upon the Messenger and foremost Prophet.

10 Truly the son of ʿAbd Allāh (Muḥammad) has surpassed all creatures, every one, in rank and in character.

11 The peace of the Lord of the worlds, forever, upon the most sublime of the worlds, Aḥmad.

12 The blessing of the son of ʿAbd Allāh has led graces to the stillness and the motions of the pure elect.

13 The guidance of Abū l-Qāsim (Muḥammad) has illumined the breasts, with an illumination that puts to shame suns and full moons.

14 There yields to the Chosen One what yielded to the noble only by toil upon toil, among aspirations.

15 The Exalter (Ar-Rāfiʿ) has raised him with a raising that surpassed (all others), and has made purity and concord everlasting.

16 His praises have led to us righteousness, security, divine assistance and success.

17 We have attained felicity through him through whom He Who led the Sūras to him created the creatures.

18 The benefit of the Prophet for the Khadīm has been unveiled, and his love has freed the Khadīm from need of (any other) healing.

19 Allah has granted him all that he desired; upon him be His peace, from the best of fulfilments.

20 His Book is above all the Books, and its like, in what has passed, has never been written.

21 Whoever thought he could equal the Messenger will not obtain any request from his Lord.

22 Ṭā-Hā, son of ʿAbd Allāh, has surpassed everyone who has been created or will be created, with the Lord of time.

23 Toward him the prophets and messengers turn, on the Day when the precedence of any other than him is washed away.

24 He has gathered the intercession before which every other was powerless, on the Day when the promise was fulfilled.

25 Muḥammad — may Allah bless him — is the most excellent of what his Lord has created.

26 The light of the Prophet has removed the darkness, and his right guidance has removed blame.

27 His Criterion (Al-Furqān) has separated forever, from before, me from everyone who did not worship (Allah).

28 I have thanked my Lord in prose and in verse, together with the Prophet, and for me, through him, (He) has led immense things.

29 The benefit of the Messenger of Allah, the adornment of Muḍar, has become clear to me among the people of desert and town.

30 The Chosen One has led to me what he led for me, from his Lord, through his Lord, and it yielded.

PARTIE 2

Ataaba 2

31 My worship (goes) to Him Who has effaced temptations and led to me, through the Chosen One, the texts (of knowledge).

32 Our Messenger Aḥmad, through his Lord, has given rest to my whole being, and it has found rest.

33 There has yielded to me that through which wisdoms yielded to me, through the Chosen One, whom the Judge (Al-Ḥakam) has exalted.

34 Glory be to Him Who has preferred the best of envoys, our Aḥmad, above all the messengers.

35 God refused that the master of creatures be like the creatures; and (he) has guided and illumined.

36 The peace of the Lord of the Throne and the blessing upon him through whom the spiteful have softened.

37 My pens, my ink and (my) body have triumphed, in my service to him who spared me from whoever envied (me).

38 Allah has made easy for me, through the service of the Established One (with God, the Prophet), every hard thing, which “Be, and it is” (Qur’ān 36:82) has tamed.

39 The Beautiful (Al-Jamīl) has come to meet me with glad tidings, in the service of the Chosen One, possessor of the sign.

40 The blessing of the Lord of the mighty Throne and peace upon the chosen Prophet, who effaces blame.

41 I have adorned, for my Lord, with al-Māḥī (Muḥammad), years of a worship whose reward has effaced all moaning.

42 My Lord has forgiven me what came before and what came after (Qur’ān 48:2), through an Effacer (al-Māḥī) who was set foremost.

43 My Lord has turned to me with a forgiveness that washed my faults through the Prophet, and they were washed away.

44 I have thanked Him for the Prophet, recounting (the favour, Qur’ān 93:11), ever since He led to me what He led to me: so recount!

45 The Everlasting (Al-Bāqī) has increased for me, by the rank of the one who ascends (Muḥammad), what led me to gratitude through (written) leaves.

46 The graces have called me to gratitude, through praise of the thankful servant of the Lord of creatures.

47 The beauty of my praise never ceases to be gladness, in secret and openly, for the Prophet of glad tidings.

48 Toward the Prophet I have turned what closed the gate of Gehenna, and it was closed away from us.

49 I have led to the Chosen One what led to opening the gate of the Gardens, and it opened toward us.

50 I have gladdened the Best of creation with the Qur'ān, and it is right guidance and the watering-place of the thirsty.

51 Our Lord, by the rank of the Chosen One, has set a barrier between me and all that is not chosen.

52 Praise of the Elect (al-Mujtabā) has transmuted substances for me, and leads to me with good pleasure what is chosen.

53 God, through the Prophet, has driven harm toward others than me, leading goodness to me.

54 My life has become good through the chosen Prophet, and what the God-fearing have loved has yielded to me.

55 I have intended to thank my King for the Prophet, a mercy for every near one and (every) stranger.

56 God has led to me that through which my being His servant, the Khadīm, has appeared and become renowned.

57 I am well pleased with Him Who has granted me my being His servant, attendant of the best of existence.

58 The Qur'ān has come to meet me with sweetness, and the Best of creatures has led to me its recitation.

59 The Ḥadīth of the Best of creation is companionship for me, after the Book of Him Who is the (true) Companion.

60 The Bestower (Al-Wahhāb) has granted me intimate converse, and He — exalted be He — is the best one with whom to converse intimately.

PARTIE 3

Ataaba 3

61 I have held within the Qur’ān a secret that must remain, forever, veiled.

62 I recite the Book, well pleased with Him Who sent (it) down, Who is well pleased with me, effacing my wavering.

63 May the best Self-Sufficient One (Aṣ-Ṣamad) bless our master Muḥammad, greeting him with peace.

64 The Gatherer (Al-Jāmiʿ) has bestowed benefits on me, (making me), through Him, free of need for defenders.

65 He Who protected me from hypocrisy has effaced my faults, through the Chosen One, who surpassed all creation.

66 The peace of Him Who accepted from me the (religious) obligation upon him through whom I paid off the debt.

67 My heart has rejoiced at the turning toward me of my Lord's reward, for what I have written in rajaz metre.

68 There has turned to me, from the Beautiful (Al-Jamīl), the adornment of the Everlasting, without obscurity.

69 The Enricher (Al-Mughnī) has made me a master, (free) of kings through Him, and through al-Māḥī (free) of the initiatic wayfaring.

70 Allah has set me before the servants, through the Chosen One who makes the footsteps firm.

71 I have obtained the gifts without earning (by my own strength), but through God, and God suffices me.

72 The Everlasting, the Beautiful, has extended to me a succour, through the Chosen One who made my tongue upright.

73 Our Prophet Aḥmad is my provision (toward) God; through him Allah has spared me the harm of every heedless one.

74 I have been lavish toward him, ever since I reached discernment, with the pens; and (he) has led to me what effaced all blame.

75 The Bountiful (Al-Mannān) has favoured me with aspirations, and through the Prophet the heart grows pure for me.

76 The Supreme Judge (Ad-Dayyān) has favoured me with purity, and through the Prophet disobedience has left me.

77 The hearts of the people of Allah have turned toward me, by the rank of an Effacer (al-Māḥī) whose loftiness has shone upon me.

78 The praises of the Best of the worlds have drawn out of me the faults of the soul, and they have gone out.

79 Muḥammad: his outward purifies the outward of whoever aspires to purification.

80 Our Prophet: his inward sanctifies, purifies whoever has been seized by darkness.

81 His praise has drawn to me, in secret, my whole being, and has spared (it) harm and evil.

82 My worship is the affirmation of my Lord's Oneness and the praise of him who drove the idol toward others than me.

83 The peace of Him Who is exalted above all likeness upon the Prophet who surpasses (his) peers.

84 To me Allah has led, through the Prophet, the glad tidings of "There is no god but Allah".

85 The Self-Sufficient (Aṣ-Ṣamad) has effaced the turning of harm toward me, from before, through him who is the Prophet Muḥammad.

86 Toward others than me the Antichrist (ad-Dajjāl) turns, with all that is allied to him, and the fears.

87 God, through the Prophet, has severed forever (every tie) between me and all that is not praiseworthy.

88 The prowling (around me) of whoever does not worship Allah has turned toward others than me, and good pleasure turns toward me.

89 Glory be to Him Who, toward the Gardens, has preserved my whole being, (I) a servant holding fast to Him.

PARTIE 4

Ataaba 4

90 I have been enriched by Allah together with the Prophet, and He, through him, is for me with what is well-pleasing.

91 I have won preservation from impurities in this abode and in that (of the Hereafter).

92 Through Allah I have sought, through the Prophet, purity, safety, glad tidings and pardon.

93 O Appreciative (Ash-Shakūr), be for me, by Your noble Face, with glad tidings and ease that never cease.

94 By Your noble Face, purify my years of all turbidity, O Lord of creatures and of the Command.

95 Join to the striving of the first forerunners (Qur'ān 9:100) my striving, and give glad tidings of me to all the most perfect.

96 Accept my gratitude, O Appreciative, and protect me until the Gardens, with aspirations and safety.

97 I have repented to You today: so accept the repentance, and grant me, by the right of Your Face, the Book.

98 Favour me forever with purity, and through health make me free of need for healing.

99 Lead to me the sciences of the pure elect, like (those) of the saints and the learned, and make my attainment great for me.

100 To You (I address) today my discourse, with intercession, through the Chosen, the Elect, light of the messengers.

101 Increase me in knowledge, by the sanctity of the Prophet, and turn no injustice toward my sides.

102 Teach me, O God, a knowledge never seen for any other than me, and for any other than me it shall not be seen.

103 Lead to me the unveiling of the saints, and lead to me the knowledge of the others (the learned), and be lavish to me with success.

104 Grant me by grace felicity, by the right of Your Face, and the wonder that breaks the customary course.

105 Favour me with the glad tidings of time, until the Gardens, and be for me with safety.

106 Accept my gifts for the Prophet, out of generosity, O best of those who have enriched and of those who have been generous.

107 Gladden the Messenger of Allah with the letters of it (this poem), and be lavish to me forever with good.

108 Lead to the Messenger of Allah, adornment of mankind, from me, glad tidings beyond counting.

109 Muḥammad — may Allah bless him — his loftiness has become clear to every (being) endowed with reason.

110 That Abū l-Qāsim (Muḥammad) is the light of the prophets has become clear to all but the wretched dullards.

111 The Book of Aḥmad has abrogated every other, and truly it shall not be abrogated by any other.

112 Our Prophet: his Book has completed what (came) before it, and has adorned every other.

113 The peace of Him Who is exalted above consort and child (Qurʾān 72:3) upon the son of ʿAbd Allāh, the most excellent of offspring.

114 He to Whom none is equal (Qurʾān 112:4) has sent Muḥammad, and has already spared (us) whoever denied.

115 O Splitter (Al-Fāliq, Qurʾān 6:95), bless forever and grant peace to him whose precedence is known.

116 O Benefactor (An-Nāfiʿ), bless with a peace that has no end him who is the beginning of the noble and (their) seal.

أَطَابَ

Ataaba

أَطَابَ لِي الْمَمَرَّ كَالْأَوْطَانِ * بَاقٍ أَعَاذَنِي مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ

« M'a rendu agréable le passage (de l'exil) comme les patries un Éternel (Al-Bāqī) qui m'a préservé de Satan. »

« Ataaba » est un khassida de Cheikh Ahmadou Bamba Khadimou Rassoul, guide spirituel et fondateur de Touba. Cette édition réunit ses 116 vers, répartis en 4 parties, en arabe vocalisé, avec leur translittération et leur traduction.

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